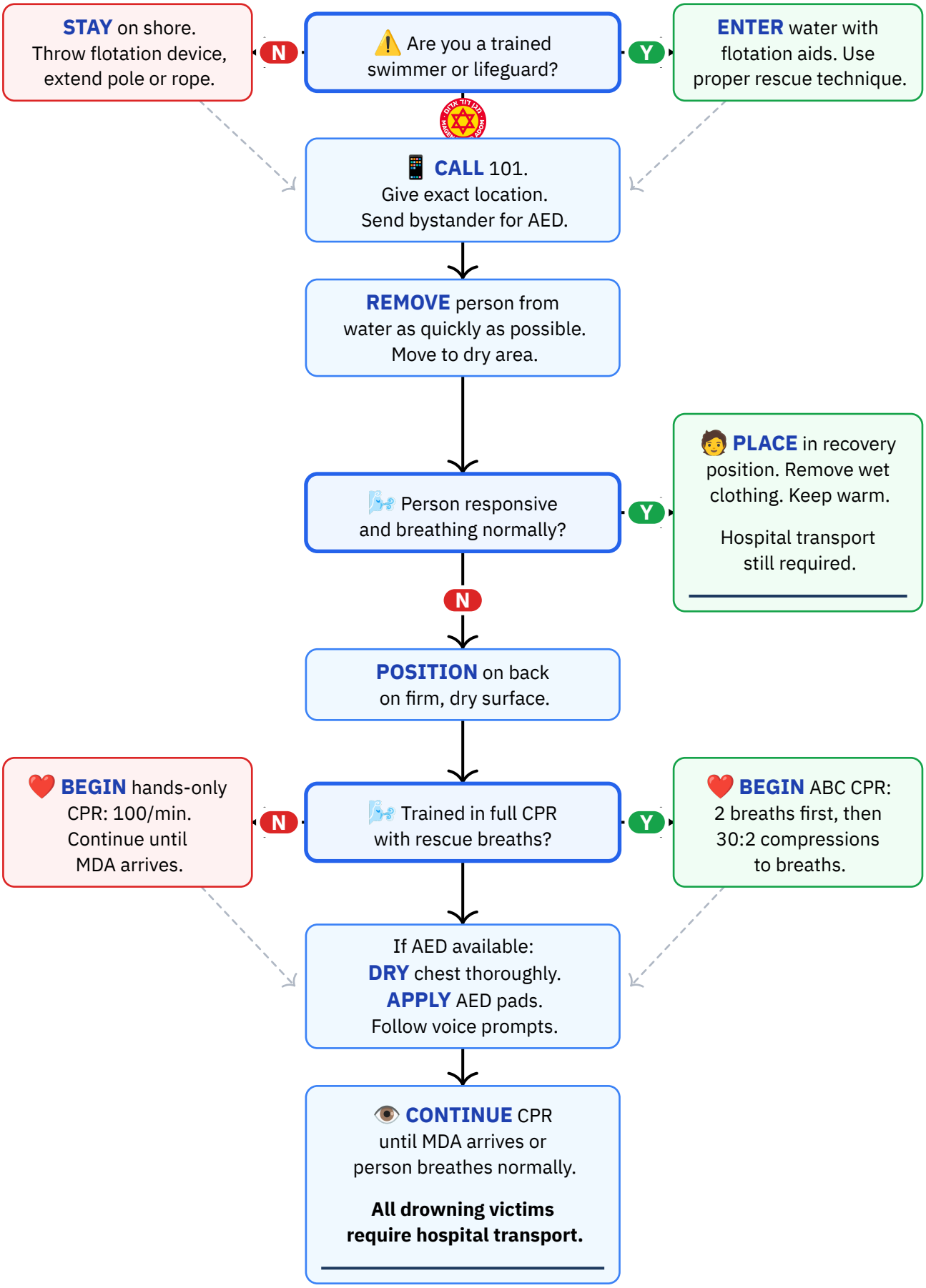

Personal reference only — not medical advice

Daniel Rosehill · share with attribution

Reference Notes

DO NOT:

✕ **Do NOT enter the water** unless you are a trained swimmer — untrained rescuers frequently become victims.
✕ **Do NOT attempt to remove water from the lungs** — MDA states this is impossible, dangerous, and wastes critical time.
✕ **Do NOT perform the Heimlich manoeuvre** or turn the person upside down to "drain" water.
✕ **Do NOT use an AED on a wet patient** or wet surface — dry the chest and move to dry area first.
✕ **Do NOT allow a near-drowning victim to refuse hospital transport** — secondary drowning and electrolyte imbalances can be fatal hours later.
✕ **Do NOT stop CPR** until the person breathes on their own or MDA takes over.
✕ **Do NOT delay calling 101** — call immediately, even before attempting rescue if alone.

Equipment needed:

— AED (defibrillator) — commonly at lifeguard stations and public facilities
— Reaching aids (pole, rope, flotation device) for water rescue
— Dry blankets or clothing to keep victim warm after extraction

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Drowning	טביעה	tvi-A
Water	מים	MA-yim
Swimming pool	בריכה	bre-KHA
Beach	חוף	khof
Lifeguard	מציל	ma-TSIL
He is not breathing	הוא לא נושם	hu lo no-SHEM
CPR	החייאה	ha-kha-ya-A
Defibrillator	דפיברילטור	de-fib-ri-LA-tor
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Help!	הצילו!	ha-tsi-LU!
Call an ambulance	תזמין אמבולנס	taz-MIN am-bu-LANS
Recovery position	תנוחת התאוששות	tnu-KHAT hit-o-she-SHUT

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — Drowning First Aid Guidance
URL: https://www.mdais.org/101/drowning
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